DRUGS · NASAL PREPARATIONS

Ipratropium nasal spray

Ipratropium bromide is an antimuscarinic. As a nasal spray, it blocks the parasympathetic supply to the seromucous glands and stops watery rhinorrhoea within minutes, without affecting congestion, sneezing or itch. It is the drug for a "runny tap" nose: vasomotor rhinitis, gustatory rhinitis, rhinitis in the elderly, and the common cold.

1 CHAPTER ONE At a glance

The drug on one page.

1.1 Summary

IPRATROPIUM NASAL SPRAY

	SUMMARY
Class	Short-acting muscarinic antagonist
How it works	Blocks acetylcholine at muscarinic receptors on nasal glands, reducing secretion
ENT uses	Non-allergic (vasomotor) rhinitis with predominant rhinorrhoea; gustatory rhinitis; elderly rhinitis ("old man's drip"); persistent rhinorrhoea in allergic rhinitis despite a steroid; common cold
Adult dose	2 sprays (21 micrograms each, 0.03%) into each nostril two or three times daily
Child dose	Licensed from 12 years in the UK
Avoid	Caution in glaucoma (avoid spraying into eyes), prostatic hypertrophy and urinary retention
Pregnancy	Limited data; use if needed

2 CHAPTER TWO Using it in ENT

Indications.

2.1 Choosing it

It does not help **congestion**, so it is not a substitute for a nasal steroid where blockage is the main problem; combine the two when both symptoms are present. For gustatory rhinitis, use it 15 to 30 minutes before meals.

3 CHAPTER THREE Safety

What goes wrong.

3.1 Adverse effects

Nasal dryness, epistaxis, irritation; rarely anticholinergic effects (dry mouth, blurred vision, urinary retention).

4 CHAPTER FOUR For the examination

What the examiner wants to hear.

4.1 Viva essentials

WHAT THE EXAMINER IS LOOKING FOR

- Which symptom it treats and why (parasympathetic secretomotor supply).
- Its place in non-allergic and elderly rhinitis.

4.2 Common pitfalls

COMMON PITFALLS

- Expecting ipratropium to relieve nasal obstruction.

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